

Φανοκλῆς ὁ ἐλεγιογράφος

Phanocles the Elegiac Poet on Orpheus

eul_aid: iys

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Ἑπική [Epic \(Homeric\)](#) (frg)
Domain: Ποίσις [Poetry](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Phanocles was a Greek elegiac poet of the Hellenistic period, generally dated to the late fourth or early third century BCE. He is considered a contemporary of poets like Hermesianax and Alexander Aetolus, often associated with the intellectual milieu of early Ptolemaic Alexandria. No specific biographical details survive.

He is known only for his fragmentarily preserved elegiac poem **Erotes** or **Kaloi**. The work is lost, and its content is reconstructed from quotations in later authors, primarily Stobaeus and Athenaeus.

Phanocles's significance lies in his contribution to a subgenre of Hellenistic elegy: mythological catalog poetry with homoerotic themes. **Erotes** systematically narrated myths of gods' loves for mortal youths, such as Dionysus for Adonis and Apollo for Hyacinthus, using a formulaic structure. The poem represents Hellenistic scholarly poetry, adapting archaic form to mythographic content, and influenced later poets like Parthenius.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ὀρφέως · [Fragments on Orpheus](#) · 11 passages